

Can someone give me some hope about the fact we'll run out of water in 13 years because of AI?

Posted by u/blightnshiningarmour • 0 points • 11 comments

I am aware this is the most "first world problems" thing ever, there are already so many people facing not having drinking water in our world, this concept isn't new and affects people every day and I fully acknowledge that

but I've been really struggling with this as someone who will only be in my mid thirties by the "no water" prediction date, I don't know how to keep going in the mean time without having the worse impending feeling of doom that it consumes me completely every day, i'm also severely disabled and mostly house/bed bound so I sadly have a lot of time with my thoughts

even if it's not "it might not happen", can someone give me some hope? even just realistically what would happen with a lack of drinking water, any tips on keeping on going until then?

Comments

u/pandaappleblossom • 2 points • 2026-02-19 06:49 UTC

Animal agriculture (for both eating them and using their fur, skin, and feathers) uses more water and pollutes Way more and you don't have to eat animals or their secretions. People are so performative when they wont just go at least plant based.

u/Economy-Fee5830 • 1 points • 2026-02-18 23:52 UTC

This is the source of the idea:

> A 2026 United Nations University report warns that the world has entered an era of "global water bankruptcy," where water systems are depleted faster than they can replenish, causing irreversible damage. Approximately 4 billion people face severe water scarcity at least one month per year. This crisis is driven by over-extraction, pollution, and climate change.

<https://unu.edu/inweh/news/world-enters-era-of-global-water-bankruptcy>

u/snek_kogae • 1 points • 2026-02-18 23:42 UTC

First of all it's not that we'll suddenly have zero water. It's about increasing water stress. It will change our habits the hard way later, or we can change our habits the easy way now.

Secondly, one of the most important things in addressing global water shortages is focussing on the big things first. You've heard a lot of big numbers about AI, or stories of it directly causing **local** water shortages. But **globally**, there are much bigger fish to fry.

No one who's serious about fixing a problem will insist on focussing on something hard to achieve and unsequential even if it is achieved.

It doesn't mean we have to go vegan either. It's about **budget**, not using zero water - because animal agriculture is so massive as cause, even a partial fix will make a much bigger difference than magically stopping all AI

BUT: global water shortages manifest as more and more local water shortages. If AI is already causing local water shortages, you stop AI there. And the fact that people are ready to blame AI for everything (even when not valid) is your hopium - stopping data centres excess water consumption is a win.

BUT AGAIN: stopping water wasting AI data centres will not stop global water shortages. We need to focus on all the non-AI water wasting data centres. Our lawns. Golf courses. Degree of meat (especially beef consumed).

Also yes! AI is a bubble (at least insofar as the big tech massive data centre use etc etc - that will go down, as well as water efficiency because tech CEOs want "social license" (they worried about vandalism))

When we're serious about stopping global water shortages, we need to reject the culture of thought terminating online zingers and insist on proper evidence-based critical thinking.

And as I was going back and emphasising things, it occurred to me that I have to stress: no: I'm not AI. I'm just an irritable autistic person

u/DanoPinyon • 1 points • 2026-02-18 23:41 UTC

We won't run out of water in 13 years, but that's a good lol nonetheless.

u/blightnshiningarmour • 1 points • 2026-02-18 23:59 UTC

okay thankyou, I have been fed lies and didn't research enough to prove myself wrong 😭 I feel really stupid i'm normally better than this

u/skr_replicator • 3 points • 2026-02-18 23:39 UTC

If AI eat watter for about 1000 families, then it's only taking about less than 1 millionths of our water budget. Is that enough to blame all water scarcity on that?

u/blightnshiningarmour • 1 points • 2026-02-18 23:56 UTC

i'm not blaming all water scarcity on it, i'm saying it's predicted to be the catalyst of water scarcity in the first world, if we keep going with building new data centres the way we have been it will be a LOT more than 1000 families, australia is predicted to soon build the biggest data centre yet and it will take at least 92 mega litres of water a year from Sydney

u/kevinmitchell63 • 1 points • 2026-02-18 23:32 UTC

Ok I'll try.

I don't know much about AI but.... I am pretty comfortable saying that, in the entire history of humanity, never has a "thing" looked so much like a bubble and then turned out to NOT be a bubble.

I think most of those "data centres" will never be built. Yes, there will be an AI industry but, between now and then, I betcha most of these companies will disappear.....

u/DrDFox • 5 points • 2026-02-18 23:31 UTC

Where are you getting the idea that we will run out of drinking water?

u/_Svankensen_ • 6 points • 2026-02-18 23:31 UTC

Unless you are talking about a specific aquifer in a specific place under a specific scenario, we are DEFINITELY not running out of water in 13 years because of AI. Simple as that. Question your sources. The world is not ending. Climate change is terrible, but it is not chicxulub. Don't panic. Activism and vote green. That's all you can do, and it is enough.

u/prostateExamination • 1 points • 2026-02-18 23:29 UTC

you have been fed lies.. all sides use propaganda.. under no circumstance is that even close to happening.

u/snek_kogae • 2 points • 2026-02-18 23:48 UTC

Being a data scientist as Chat GPT was released as a massive truth bomb for me: MOST people online talk confidently about stuff they don't know. Don't listen to them, read those boring reports etc

We should be boring, correct people, not internet-brained karma machines